API Manual Testing Interview Question Bank

Deduplicated, ranked by importance and grouped by topic
Prepared for a Software Tester with 4+ years of experience

Questions in your original document	**137**
Exact duplicates removed (same question, different wording of punctuation or case)	**2**
Near-duplicates merged (same question asked in different words)	**52**
Unique questions in this PDF	**83**

Section 1: Critical (Must Prepare)	22 questions
Section 2: High Priority	38 questions
Section 3: Medium Priority	20 questions
Section 4: Low Priority / Quick Revision	3 questions

How to Use This Document

Questions are ordered by how likely they are to be asked and how much weight interviewers give them for a tester with 4+ years of experience. Work top to bottom: finish Section 1 before you spend time on Section 3 or 4. Inside each section the questions are grouped by topic, and within each topic the most important question comes first.

A red tag such as **[asked x3 in your bank]** means the same question showed up several times in your original document (in different wording). Repetition is a good signal that it is a frequently asked question.

Section	What it means
Critical (Must Prepare) 22 questions	Asked in almost every API testing interview at 4+ years. Give a precise definition plus a Postman or project example.
High Priority 38 questions	Frequent practical and scenario questions. Answer with your approach: what you send, what you assert and what can go wrong.
Medium Priority 20 questions	Occasionally asked, usually as follow-ups or when your resume mentions the topic.
Low Priority / Quick Revision 3 questions	Niche protocols and rare scenarios. Know the one-line idea.

What Interviewers Look For (4+ Years)

Topic	What the interviewer is testing
API Testing Fundamentals	Do you know what API testing covers and how it differs from UI and unit testing?
REST, SOAP & HTTP	Precise answers on methods, PUT vs PATCH, idempotency, status codes and REST vs SOAP.
Postman	Hands-on use: collections, environments, variables, scripts, chaining and Newman, not just 'I sent a request'.
Response Validation	What you check beyond the status code: schema, headers, data integrity, error handling, timeouts.
Authentication & Security	Basic vs OAuth vs JWT, authentication vs authorization, and basic security and rate-limit checks.
Scenario-Based	Judgement on real situations: no documentation, async responses, dependencies, pagination, caching, concurrency.
API Automation	How you move from Postman to code: RestAssured specifications, logging, JSON validation.
Contract Testing	Consumer-driven contracts (Pact) and how contract testing differs from schema validation.

Note: the HTTP/REST basics (status codes, PUT vs PATCH, idempotency, REST vs SOAP) were repeated many times in your file, so they are merged and ranked highest. Your file's title was 'API Manul Testing' (typo in the original).

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Topic Finder (all sections for one topic)

Use this if you want to study one topic at a time. Each number links to that topic's questions inside a section.

Topic	S1	S2	S3	S4	Total
API Testing Fundamentals	2 Qs, p.5	3 Qs, p.7	3 Qs, p.9	-	**8**
REST, SOAP & HTTP Concepts	6 Qs, p.5	6 Qs, p.7	1 Qs, p.9	-	**13**
Postman: Usage, Scripting & Chaining	7 Qs, p.5	2 Qs, p.7	4 Qs, p.9	-	**13**
Response Validation & Test Design	3 Qs, p.5	5 Qs, p.7	1 Qs, p.9	-	**9**
Authentication, Security & Rate Limiting	2 Qs, p.5	4 Qs, p.7	1 Qs, p.9	1 Qs, p.10	**8**
Scenario-Based API Testing	1 Qs, p.6	12 Qs, p.7	7 Qs, p.9	2 Qs, p.10	**22**
API Automation (RestAssured) & Java	1 Qs, p.6	3 Qs, p.8	-	-	**4**
API Contract Testing	-	3 Qs, p.8	3 Qs, p.9	-	**6**

S1 = Critical, S2 = High, S3 = Medium, S4 = Low priority.

Section 1: Critical (Must Prepare) (22 questions)

Asked in almost every API testing interview at 4+ years. Give a precise definition plus a Postman or project example.

API Testing Fundamentals (2)

1. What is API testing and why is it important? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
2. What challenges have you faced in API testing?

REST, SOAP & HTTP Concepts (6)

3. Explain the HTTP methods used in API testing (GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE). **[asked x3 in your bank]**
4. What is the difference between PUT and PATCH? **[asked x4 in your bank]**
5. What is idempotency? Which HTTP methods are idempotent? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
6. Explain HTTP status codes, their categories and the ones you commonly use. **[asked x5 in your bank]**
7. What is a REST API and what are its principles?
8. What is the difference between SOAP and REST APIs? How do you test SOAP APIs? **[asked x6 in your bank]**

Postman: Usage, Scripting & Chaining (7)

9. What is Postman and why is it widely used in API testing? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
10. What are Collections and Environments in Postman? How do you import/export them? **[asked x4 in your bank]**
11. What are variables in Postman (global, environment, collection) and how do you use them?
12. How do you chain requests: capture a value from one response and pass it to another request? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
13. What is the difference between the Pre-request Script and the Tests tab?
14. How do you automate API tests in Postman and validate responses with scripts? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
15. How do you implement data-driven API testing (Postman data files, parameterization)? **[asked x3 in your bank]**

Response Validation & Test Design (3)

16. How do you validate an API response (status code, body, headers, response time)? What are the most common validations? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
17. How do you validate the JSON schema? What is schema validation and how do you test if a response schema changes? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
18. How do you test API error handling and error codes? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

Authentication, Security & Rate Limiting (2)

19. Explain authentication types (Basic, OAuth, Bearer token). How do you handle authentication in Postman? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
20. What is the difference between Authentication and Authorization?

Scenario-Based API Testing (1)

21. How do you approach testing a new API when no documentation is available, or the requirements are incomplete and the behaviour changes often? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

API Automation (RestAssured) & Java (1)

22. API automation: RestAssured vs Postman tests. When do you use which?

Section 2: High Priority (38 questions)

Frequent practical and scenario questions. Answer with your approach: what you send, what you assert and what can go wrong.

API Testing Fundamentals (3)

23. What is an API and how does it work? What are the different types of APIs? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
24. What are the common types of API testing?
25. What is the difference between smoke, regression and load testing in APIs?

REST, SOAP & HTTP Concepts (6)

26. What are headers, body and parameters in requests and responses? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
27. How do you handle query parameters and path parameters? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
28. What is the difference between URI, URL and endpoint? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
29. What is JSON and why is it preferred over XML? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
30. How do you test APIs with different content types (JSON, XML, form data)? Raw vs form-data body? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
31. What is API versioning and what are the common strategies?

Postman: Usage, Scripting & Chaining (2)

32. How do you run Postman tests from the command line (Newman) and in CI?
33. Explain the structure of a request in Postman.

Response Validation & Test Design (5)

34. How do you handle timeouts, retries and error scenarios in API testing? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
35. How do you validate data integrity in API testing?
36. How do you handle dynamic payloads?
37. How do you ensure API backward compatibility?
38. What are API testing best practices?

Authentication, Security & Rate Limiting (4)

39. How do you test API authentication (OAuth, JWT)? How do you handle tokens, OAuth and CORS in Postman? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
40. What is the difference between OAuth 1.0 and OAuth 2.0? When do you use each? Write a sample.
41. How do you test API security (in Postman)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
42. How do you test API rate limiting (throttling)? **[asked x3 in your bank]**

Scenario-Based API Testing (12)

43. How do you test API pagination? **[asked x3 in your bank]**
44. How do you test sorting and filtering in APIs?
45. How do you test APIs that return asynchronous responses? **[asked x2 in your bank]**

46. How do you test APIs that depend on other services (and test APIs in a microservices architecture)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
47. How do you test APIs with third-party integrations?
48. How do you validate API caching behaviour? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
49. How do you test APIs under failure scenarios?
50. How do you test API concurrency issues?
51. How do you test the performance of an API (Postman, product search API)? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
52. What if the API response is slow but the UI has no timeout handling?
53. How do you test APIs that behave differently for different users (roles)?
54. How do you test APIs with file uploads in Postman?

API Automation (RestAssured) & Java (3)

55. Explain RequestSpecification and ResponseSpecification in RestAssured.
56. How do you log request and response details?
57. How do you validate a JSON response using Java while testing APIs?

API Contract Testing (3)

58. What is API contract testing and why is it important? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
59. What tools are used for API contract testing? What is Pact and how does it work? **[asked x2 in your bank]**
60. What is the difference between schema validation and API contract testing?

Section 3: Medium Priority (20 questions)

Occasionally asked, usually as follow-ups or when your resume mentions the topic.

API Testing Fundamentals (3)

61. What is the difference between API testing and unit testing?
62. What is the difference between functional and non-functional API testing?
63. What tools are commonly used for API testing?

REST, SOAP & HTTP Concepts (1)

64. What are the advantages of RESTful APIs?

Postman: Usage, Scripting & Chaining (4)

65. How do you integrate Postman into your project?
66. How do you keep Postman environments in sync across teams?
67. What are common mistakes in Postman testing?
68. How do you mock APIs in Postman?

Response Validation & Test Design (1)

69. How do you test APIs with complex JSON structures?

Authentication, Security & Rate Limiting (1)

70. How do you test data encryption in API/DB?

Scenario-Based API Testing (7)

71. How do you test versioned APIs?
72. How do you test webhooks in Postman?
73. How do you test GraphQL APIs in Postman?
74. How do you test APIs with file downloads?
75. How do you test an API migration from monolith to microservices?
76. How do you test APIs with scheduled jobs?
77. How do you test localization in APIs?

API Contract Testing (3)

78. What are the key components of an API contract?
79. How do you ensure backward compatibility in API contract testing?
80. What are the challenges of API contract testing?

Section 4: Low Priority / Quick Revision (3 questions)

Niche protocols and rare scenarios. Know the one-line idea.

Authentication, Security & Rate Limiting (1)

81. How do you test APIs that require digital signatures?

Scenario-Based API Testing (2)

82. How do you test gRPC APIs in Postman?
83. How do you test an API that returns streaming data?